

CARLANDRA WILLIAMS

Senior Cloud FinOps Analyst | FinOps Product Owner

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Senior Cloud FinOps Analyst with 5+ years building FinOps as a service across \$200M+ AWS, Azure, and hybrid cloud portfolios. Strong product ownership and Business Systems Analysis background—built dashboards, KPI frameworks, and self-service capabilities that drove cultural adoption at scale. Deep expertise in Apptio FinOps tooling, delivering C-suite and Board-level insights.

TECHNICAL PROFICIENCIES

FinOps Tooling & Advanced Analytics: Apptio Cloudability (Advanced), Apptio BI (Advanced), Turbonomic (hands-on POC experience), VMware CloudHealth, AWS Cost Management Suite, FOCUS Standard

Business Systems Analysis & Product Ownership: Requirements elicitation, Process mapping, Stakeholder facilitation, Product roadmap development, Backlog prioritization, KPI & adoption metrics, Self-service capability design, Documentation & communication strategies

Financial Governance & Optimization: Enterprise discount programs (Savings Plans, Reserved Instances, commitment strategies), multi-cloud cost attribution, Unit economics modeling, Budget forecasting and variance analysis, Anomaly detection, Optimization recommendation workflows

Data Analysis & Executive Storytelling: SQL (Advanced: MS SQL Server, BigQuery), BI Platforms (Power BI, Tableau, Looker), Excel (Advanced: Pivot tables, macros, financial modeling), Dashboard development, Executive-ready narratives, technical writing for documentation

Cloud & Hybrid Platforms: AWS (Expert: EC2, S3, Lambda, RDS, CloudWatch, Cost Explorer, CUR), Azure (Exposure: FOCUS 2.0 compliance, hybrid environments), GCP (Exposure: multi-cloud cost management), On-prem and hybrid architectures, Multi-tenant SaaS cost governance

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Smarsh Inc. | Senior Cloud FinOps Analyst | 2024 – Present

- Product Owner for FinOps as a service: Built reporting capabilities, KPI frameworks, self-service documentation, and intake workflows across 15+ products and 8 global regions.
- Built executive dashboards in Cloudability and Power BI with repeatable analyses for cost anomalies, variance drivers, and optimization opportunities. Translated data into insights and actionable recommendations for engineering, finance, and business teams.
- Moved beyond traditional FinOps execution to drive cultural adoption through training programs, executive communications, tagging governance, and cost ownership rituals—improving self-sufficiency and enabling teams to prioritize work based on unit economics.
- Evolved FinOps operating model: backlog prioritization, roadmap development, KPI adoption metrics, and continuous improvement cycles. Improved cloud data quality by 70% through implementing FinOps principles into automated workflows and governance standards.

- Negotiated IBM Apptio Cloudability contract: eliminated overages, secured first year free with guided services, and collaborated with Engineering and Finance leadership on requirements and implementation.

Delta Air Lines | Senior Cloud FinOps Analyst, Infrastructure & Reliability | 2021 – 2024

- Led FinOps strategy for hybrid cloud environment (on-prem data centers + \$200M AWS) using Apptio Cloudability and Apptio BI. Delivered \$1.5M annual cost avoidance through analytics, workload efficiency improvements, rightsizing, and commitment strategy advisory.
- Designed FinOps Champion Network training 300+ engineers across 12 leadership teams and 45 squads. Established cost-aware design practices, office hours, playbooks, and shared accountability frameworks. Delivered \$800K in team-led optimizations and advanced maturity from Level 1 to Level 3 in 18 months.
- Architected enterprise cost allocation platform: automated tagging (92% coverage), metadata standards, chargeback integration, and reporting in BI platforms. Ensured metric definitions, data quality checks, and usability for technical and leadership audiences.
- Worked with cloud engineering to implement automation workflows, guardrails, and self-service cost tools. Built approval workflows and post-change verification to prevent regressions and accelerate time-to-act.

Apex Systems (Delta Air Lines) | Business Systems Analyst | 2019 – 2020

- Partnered with Infrastructure, Application, Security, and leadership teams to elicit requirements, facilitate cross-functional workflows, and align remediation priorities. Accelerated vulnerability remediation by 63% through process improvements.
- Developed reports and analytics using SQL (MS SQL Server) and Power BI to track vulnerability metrics, SLA compliance, and remediation progress for Managing Director presentations.
- Documented team processes, established workflow standards, and created operational playbooks to improve team efficiency and knowledge transfer.
- Supported on-prem cloud infrastructure operations: server procurement, racking, cabling, invoice reconciliation, and on-prem data center cost management.

CERTIFICATIONS & EDUCATION

FinOps Foundation: Certified Practitioner (2023-2026), Certified Engineer (2024-2026), Certified FOCUS Analyst (2025-2027)

AWS: Certified Cloud Practitioner (2022-2028), Certified AI Practitioner (2026-2029)

Oracle Cloud: OCI Foundations Associate (2025-2027), OCI AI Foundations Associate (2025-2027)

Education: Bachelor of Arts, Political Science | Georgia State University